

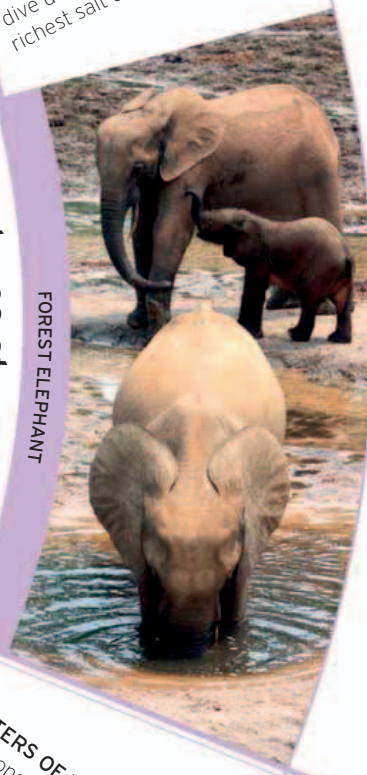
LEAP OF FAITH
The black colobus lives high in the forest canopy, but has small thumbs for an animal that relies on good grip. This is thought to reduce the risk of injury when grabbing branches mid-leap.



BLACK COLOBUS MONKEY

More than 900 butterfly species live here

SALT OF THE EARTH
Occasional natural clearings in the forest are usually filled with wet grassland and swamp. They often contain important minerals, which attract a variety of wildlife. Forest elephants dig or even dive underwater to find the richest salt deposits.



FOREST ELEPHANT

Congo trees store an estimated 8% of the Earth's forest-trapped carbon

WATERS OF LIFE
The Congo is richer in fish than any other African river, with around 700 known species, many found nowhere else on earth. These include elephantfish, which use electric fields to sense surroundings, Goliath tigerfish, whose teeth grow up to 1in (2.5cm) long, and the planet's largest freshwater pufferfish.

FRESHWATER PUFFERFISH



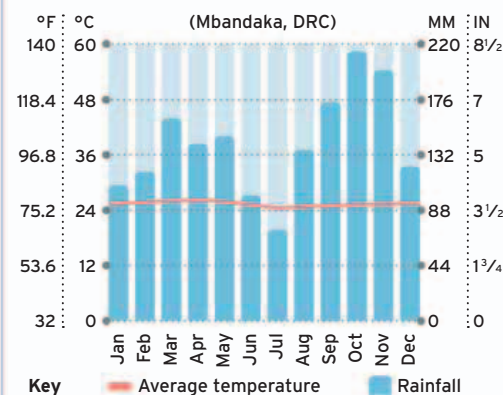
LOCATION

Central Africa, between the Gulf of Guinea and the African Great Lakes; mostly within the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) and neighboring countries.



CLIMATE

The Congo Basin is unrelentingly hot and humid, with average daytime temperatures reaching 70-80°F (21-27°C) year round. The humidity rarely drops below 80 percent, thanks to frequent rainfall, which peaks in spring and particularly fall.



HUMANS IN THE CONGO

The Congo is home to more than 250 ethnic groups. The lifestyle of modern hunter-gatherer peoples such as the seminomadic Bayaka and Bagyeli (formerly known as "pygmies") requires small groups of people to live sustainably on the land. They exchange forest goods for farmed produce grown in more settled communities.

